Scalable fit of the output-error sensitivity of a Clements unitary mesh vs. effective insertion-loss spread (fixed $\mu_L = 1$ dB, varying N)

large (exploratory) range $\sigma_{\text{eff}} \in [0, 0.5485]$ dB, 0.263 dB cap lifted: small-range parameters, no refit, qualitative only

Model (overlap-compatible, scalable in N/N_0): $E(\mu_L, \sigma_{\text{eff}}, N) = \sqrt{2}\,\sqrt{1 - e^{-(u_\mu^2 + u_\sigma^2)}}$, $u_\sigma = \dfrac{s_\sigma(N)\,\sigma_{\text{eff}}}{\sqrt{2}}$, $s_\sigma(N) = s_{\sigma,0}\,(N/N_0)^{p_\sigma}$, $N_0 = 100$

u_μ = mean-loss term of the loss fit (μ_L only); σ_{eff} = swept variable = realised std of $L \sim \text{TruncNorm}(\mu_L, \sigma_L^2; 0, 2\mu_L)$ dB (nominal σ_L derived in the sweep; no conversion and no fitted parameter here)

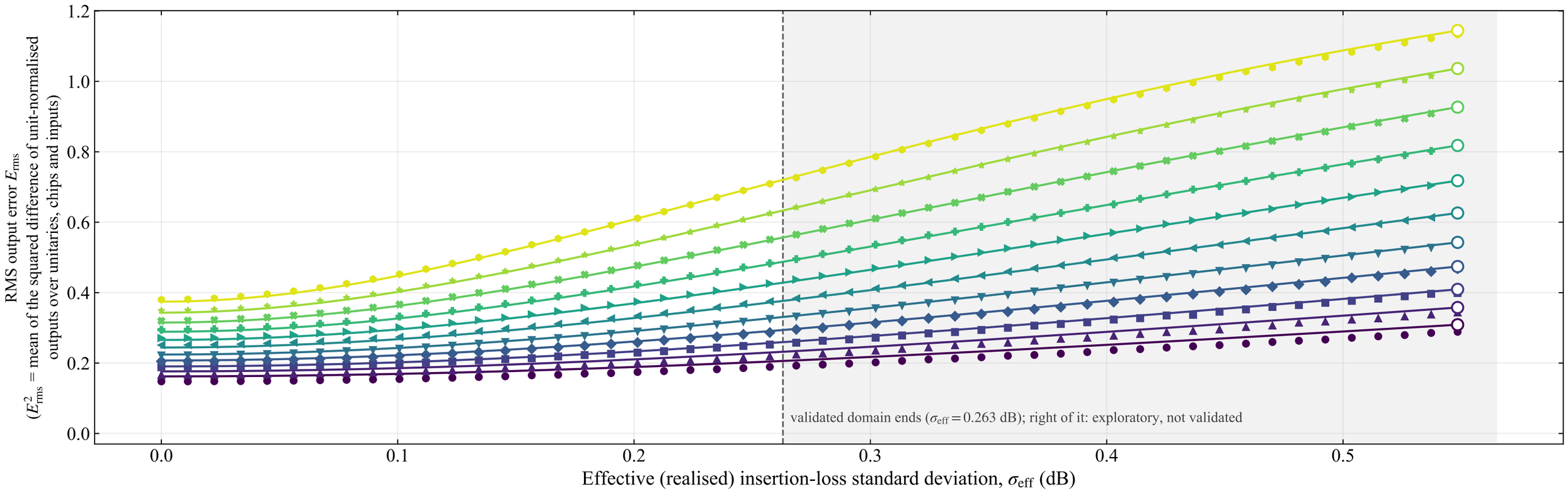
$s_{\sigma,0}$ = spread sensitivity at $N_0 = 100$ (dB^{-1}) | p_σ = network-size exponent of s_σ

Best-fit values (small range, panels A+B, equal weight per point; ± = bootstrap s.d. over unitaries): $s_{\sigma,0} = 1.11787 \pm 0.00025$ dB^{-1}, $p_\sigma = 0.51651 \pm 0.00017$

Quality on this panel (parameters NOT refitted): full surrogate (lines): RMSE = 0.00707, MAE = 0.00542, $R^2 = 0.99900$, max|ΔE| = 0.0204; off-plateau ($E \le 1.2$, 550 pts): RMSE = 0.00707

spread term alone, anchored at the measured $E(\sigma_{\text{eff}} = 0)$: RMSE = 0.00404, $R^2 = 0.99968$, max|ΔE| = 0.0133 | mean-loss term only (no spread term): RMSE = 0.25094, $R^2 = -0.25619$

Haar-random unitary U (single Clements mesh) | 7 input types × 10 draws, pooled | one forward pass $y = Ux$ | $E = \|\hat{y}^{\text{hw}} - \hat{y}^{\text{ideal}}\|_2$ | 25 unitaries × 30 chips | 50 points per curve



Network size N | $\sigma_{\text{eff}} \in [0, \sigma_{\text{top}}] = [0, 0.5485]$ dB, $\sigma_{\text{top}} = 0.95\,\mu_L/\sqrt{3}$ (cap lifted) | markers: data, lines: full surrogate, circles: end of curve

$N = 20$, $s_\sigma = 0.487$ dB^{-1}	$N = 72$, $s_\sigma = 0.943$ dB^{-1}	$N = 263$, $s_\sigma = 1.842$ dB^{-1}
$N = 28$, $s_\sigma = 0.579$ dB^{-1}	$N = 100$, $s_\sigma = 1.118$ dB^{-1}	$N = 362$, $s_\sigma = 2.173$ dB^{-1}
$N = 38$, $s_\sigma = 0.678$ dB^{-1}	$N = 138$, $s_\sigma = 1.320$ dB^{-1}	$N = 500$, $s_\sigma = 2.567$ dB^{-1}
$N = 53$, $s_\sigma = 0.805$ dB^{-1}	$N = 190$, $s_\sigma = 1.557$ dB^{-1}	